US History · Unit 6 · Level 2 (modified)

Imperialism



TODAY'S PLAN

- 🌎 Why the US became an empire
- 🧊 Alaska and Hawaii
- ⚔️ The Spanish-American War (1898)
- 🚢 The Panama Canal and the Big Stick

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



🦬 Westward expansion took Native land (Unit 2).

🏭 Factories made more goods than Americans could buy.

🤔 Quick think: how is moving west like imperialism?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Imperialism

When a strong country takes control of other lands and people.



Alaska

Land bought from Russia in 1867 for $7.2 million ("Seward's Folly").



Hawaii

Islands where US planters overthrew Queen Liliuokalani (1893); the US annexed them in 1898.



USS Maine

A US Navy ship that exploded in Cuba in 1898. Newspapers blamed Spain.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



📰 **Yellow journalism**: Exaggerated news stories written to sell papers and stir up anger.

⚔️ **Spanish-American War**: A 1898 war. The US won Puerto Rico, Guam and the Philippines.

🤠 **Rough Riders**: Theodore Roosevelt's volunteer soldiers who fought in Cuba in 1898.

🚢 **Panama Canal**: A canal across Panama (opened 1914) connecting the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans.

Learn

Why Imperialism?



Markets
sell factory goods



Resources
sugar, rubber, oil



Navy bases
coal stations for ships



Power & pride
compete with Europe

Learn

Alaska (1867)



Secretary of State **William Seward** bought Alaska from Russia for **$7.2 million**.

People called it “Seward's Folly” (a foolish buy).

Then gold was found in 1896.

Learn

Hawaii

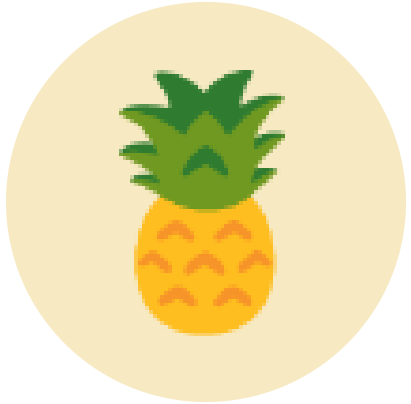
American sugar planters (like **Sanford Dole**) controlled Hawaii's economy.

In 1893 they overthrew **Queen Liliuokalani** with help from US Marines.

The US annexed Hawaii in 1898. Native Hawaiians protested.



🃏 Check 1 of 3



Who gained most from taking over Hawaii?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Queen Liliuokalani

2️⃣ American sugar planters

3️⃣ Native Hawaiians

✅ Answer · Card 1 of 3



American sugar planters

Planters wanted no tariffs on sugar.

Learn

Remember the Maine!

In Feb. 1898 the **USS Maine** exploded in Havana, Cuba. 266 sailors died.

Yellow journalism (Hearst, Pulitzer) blamed Spain with no proof.

Most experts today think it was an accident inside the ship.



🃏 Check 2 of 3



Yellow journalism is...

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ News printed on yellow paper

2️⃣ Honest reporting

3️⃣ Exaggerated news to sell papers

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 3



Exaggerated news to sell papers

It stirred up anger at Spain.

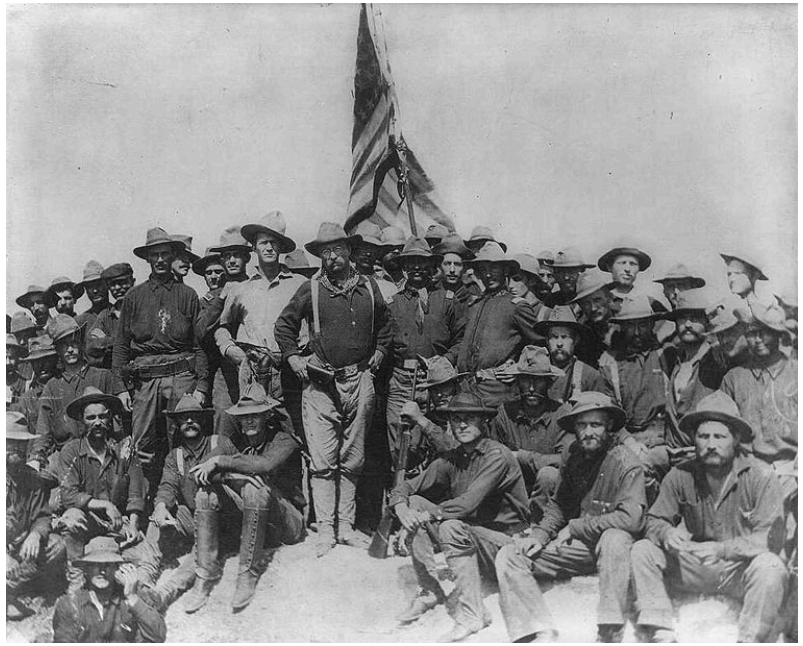
Learn

The Spanish-American War

The war lasted about **4 months** (1898).

Teddy Roosevelt and the **Rough Riders** charged up San Juan Hill.

More soldiers died from **disease** (and spoiled “embalmed beef”) than from bullets.



Learn

What the US Got



Puerto Rico
still a US territory



Guam
Pacific base



Philippines
bought for $20 million



Cuba
Platt Amendment control

Learn

The Panama Canal (1904–1914)

The US helped Panama break from **Colombia** to get the land.



Workers fought **yellow fever** and **malaria** by killing mosquitoes.

Most workers came from the Caribbean and were paid less than white workers.

🃏 Check 3 of 3



Why build the Panama Canal?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ To connect the Atlantic and Pacific for faster trips

2️⃣ To find gold

3️⃣ To stop immigrants

✅ Answer · Card 3 of 3



To connect the Atlantic and Pacific for faster trips

Ships saved about 8,000 miles.

Compare

Roosevelt's Foreign Policy



Big Stick

"Speak softly and carry a big stick"
strong navy
Great White Fleet sailed the world

Open Door

equal trade in China
no country takes it all

Wrap-Up

Recap



Imperialism
control other lands



Yellow journalism
exaggerated news



1898 war
PR, Guam, Philippines



Panama Canal
opened 1914

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Give 2 reasons the US wanted an empire.

How did yellow journalism lead to war?

Who were most canal workers and how were they treated?